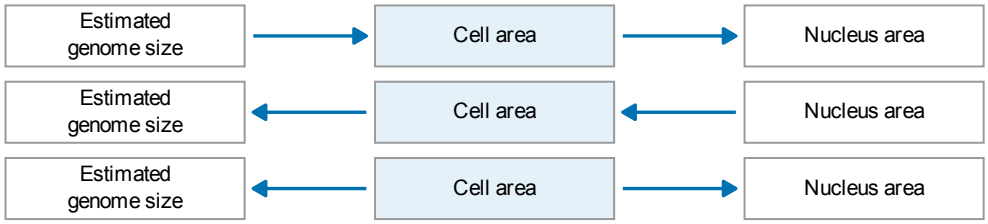
a

Alternative directions within the best-supported path class

All three predict genome–nucleus independence conditional on cell area.

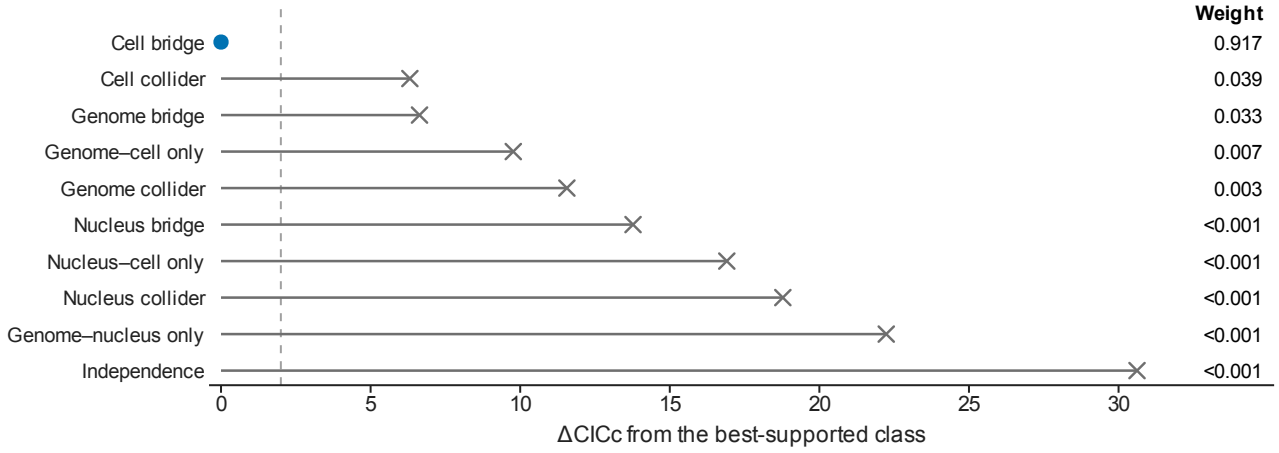


Equally compatible orientations: the analysis supports a conditional structure, while arrow direction remains unresolved.

b

Primary comparison of ten path classes

24 species; cell bridge: weight = 0.917, global-fit P = 0.9755



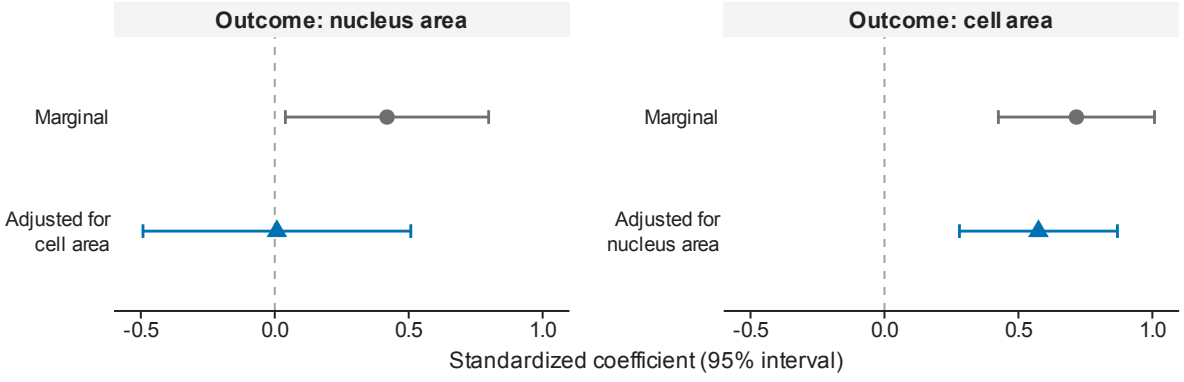
Global fit ● Pass (P ≥ 0.05) ✕ Rejected (P < 0.05)

Dashed line: ΔCICc = 2. The nucleus-bridge class is 13.77 CICc units behind the cell-bridge class.

c

Conditional associations distinguish the bridge classes

Estimated genome size is the predictor in both comparisons; 24 species.

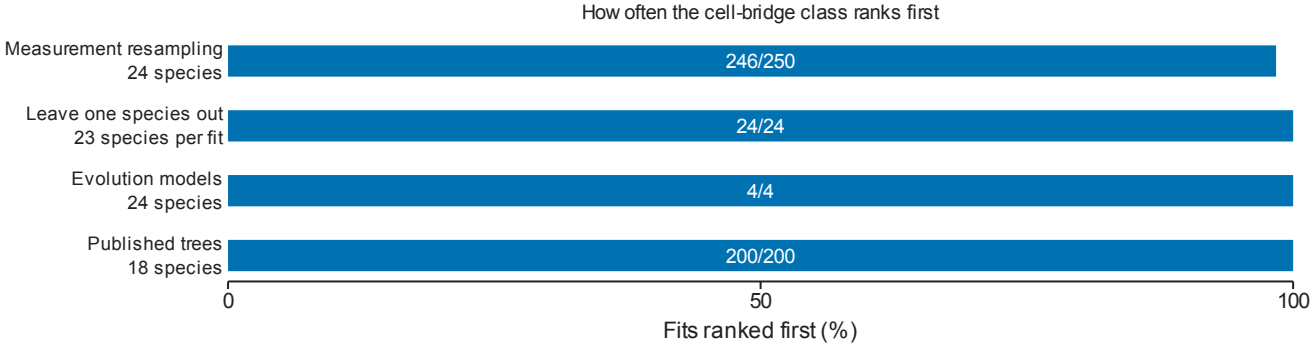


Genome–nucleus point estimate is near zero after cell-area adjustment.
Genome–cell association remains positive after nucleus-area adjustment.

d

Top-rank stability

How often the cell-bridge class ranks first



All 200 tree fits also support nucleus bridge within ΔCICc ≤ 2; 18-species support is shared.